IMS

How to use IMS

The staff guide for the office and the phone: step by step, with pictures.

FOR

Administrators, supervisors and field staff

VERSION

November 3, 2026

INSIDE

Getting started · Stock · Equipment · Counts · Forms, reports and settings · The phone app · Quick reference

HOW TO READ IT

Words in **bold** are exactly what you see on screen. Pictures use sample data, like `TOOL-0001`.

Contents

GETTING STARTED

1. Sign in
2. Who can do what
3. Stock or asset? Decide before you add an item
4. Finding your way

OFFICE: STOCK

5. Add items
6. Receive stock (a delivery came in)
7. Give out stock (Issue)
8. Move stock to another location (Transfer)
9. Find anything
10. Print labels

OFFICE: EQUIPMENT

11. Add equipment (assets)
12. See or change one asset
13. Lend equipment (Borrow)
14. Take equipment back (Return)
15. Release a borrow request from the field

OFFICE: STOCK COUNTS

16. Start a count
17. Review and close a count

FORMS, REPORTS AND SETTINGS

18. Forms (Documents)
19. Reports
20. Locations
21. Units & categories
22. Users (administrators only)
23. Audit log (administrators only)

PHONE: FIELD STAFF

24. First time (needs internet)
25. Before you go out (needs internet)
26. Count
27. Check and fix your counts (My results)
28. Send your counts (needs internet)
29. Ask to borrow equipment
30. Me

QUICK REFERENCE

31. I want to...
32. What the colors mean
33. Problems
34. Don't
35. Words used in IMS

How to use IMS

IMS (Inventory Management System) tracks two kinds of things:

- **Stock**: things you count and give out, like gloves, pants or cable ties. IMS keeps the number on hand at each location.
- **Assets**: equipment you lend out and get back, like drills or laptops. Each one has its own tag (like TOOL-0001) and its own history.

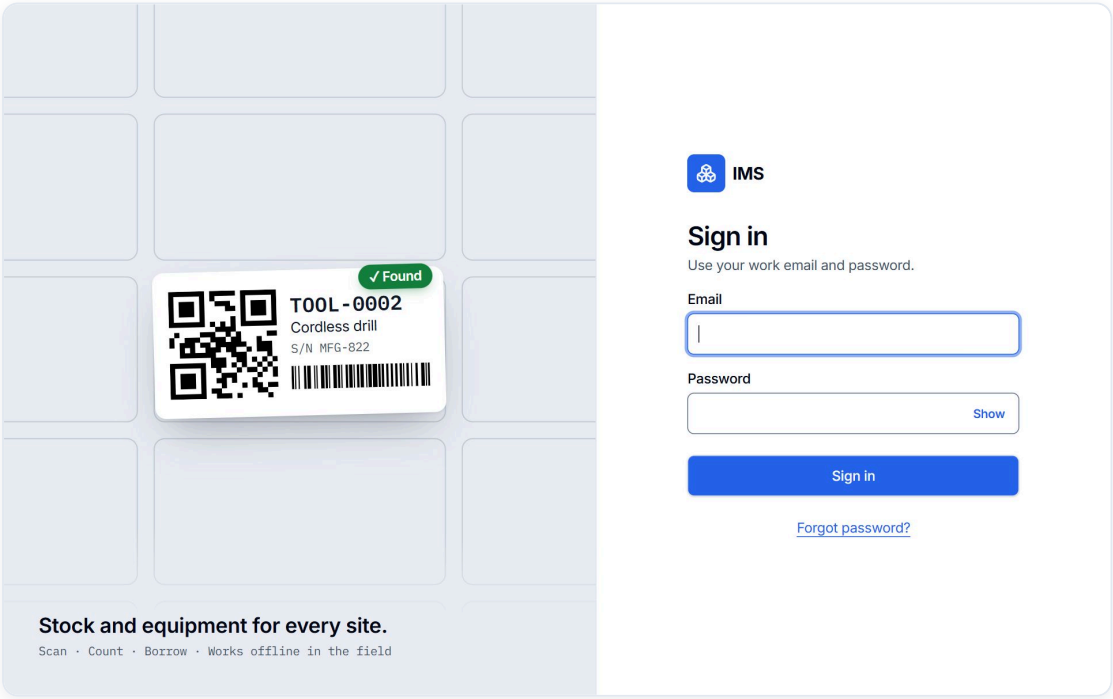
It works on a phone, tablet or computer. Words in **bold** are exactly what you see on screen. Pictures use sample data.

PART 1

Getting started

1. Sign in

1. Open the IMS link your company gave you.
2. Type your **Email** and **Password**.
3. Press **Sign in**.



Sign-in page

Forgot your password? Ask an administrator. They open **Users**, choose **Reset link** on your name, and send you the link. Open it, type a new password twice (at least 10 characters), then press **Save new password**.

Warning: 5 wrong passwords in 15 minutes lock your email for 15 minutes. An administrator's **Reset link** unlocks it straight away.

2. Who can do what

You are	You can
Administrator	Everything, at every location, plus **Users** and the **Audit log**
Supervisor	At your locations: add items and assets, receive, issue and transfer stock, lend and take back equipment, run and approve counts
Field staff	Count with your phone (works without internet) and send borrow requests

3. Stock or asset? Decide before you add an item

Ask: **"Do I need to know *which one*?"**

Stock	Asset
No. Any pair of pants is the same	Yes. *This* laptop went to Juan and is due back Friday
Kept as a number: "3 pair at MAIN-WH"	Each unit has its own tag: LAP-0001, LAP-0002…
Comes in with **Receive**	Comes in with **Add assets**
Goes out with **Issue** (it doesn't come back)	Goes out with **Borrow** and comes back with **Return**

Warning: You can't change this later. If you pick the wrong one, make a new item with a new SKU.

4. Finding your way

On a computer, the menu is on the left:

- **Dashboard**, **Stock**, **Assets**, **Counts**, **Borrowing**, **Documents**, **Reports**
- Under **Settings**: **Locations**, **Units & categories**, **Users**, **Audit log** (you only see what your role allows)
- At the bottom: your name (your **Me** page) and **Sign out**

On a phone, the bar at the bottom has **Dashboard**, **Stock**, **Scan**, **Assets** and **More** (everything else).

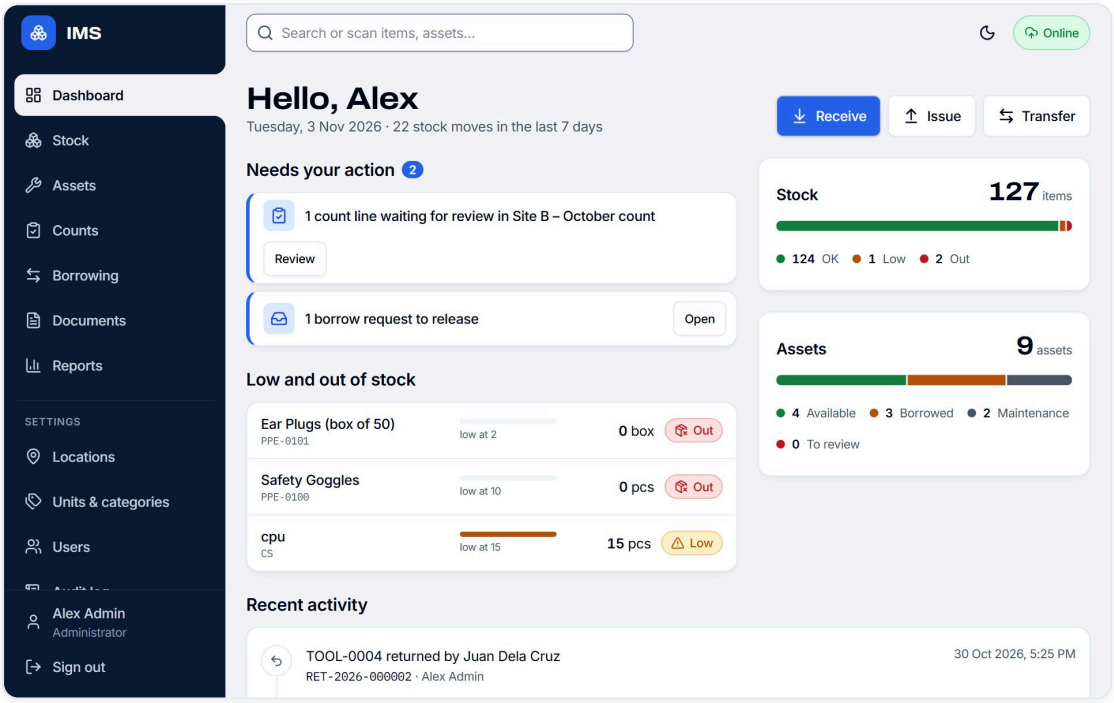
At the top of every page:

- **Search box**: type or scan a name, SKU, asset tag, serial or barcode.
- **Sun / moon button**: switches between light and dark.
- **Online** pill: green when IMS can reach the server.

The dashboard

The **Dashboard** opens when you sign in.

- **Needs your action** is your to-do list: counts to review, borrow requests, overdue loans and failed forms. Clear it and your day is done.
- **Low and out of stock** shows what needs reordering.
- **Receive**, **Issue** and **Transfer** buttons are at the top right.



Dashboard

Tip: Receive, Issue, Transfer and Borrow all use the same 4 steps: **Where** → **What** → **Who** → **Review**. The **Next** button names the next step (like **Next: What**). Nothing changes until you press the confirm button on the last step.

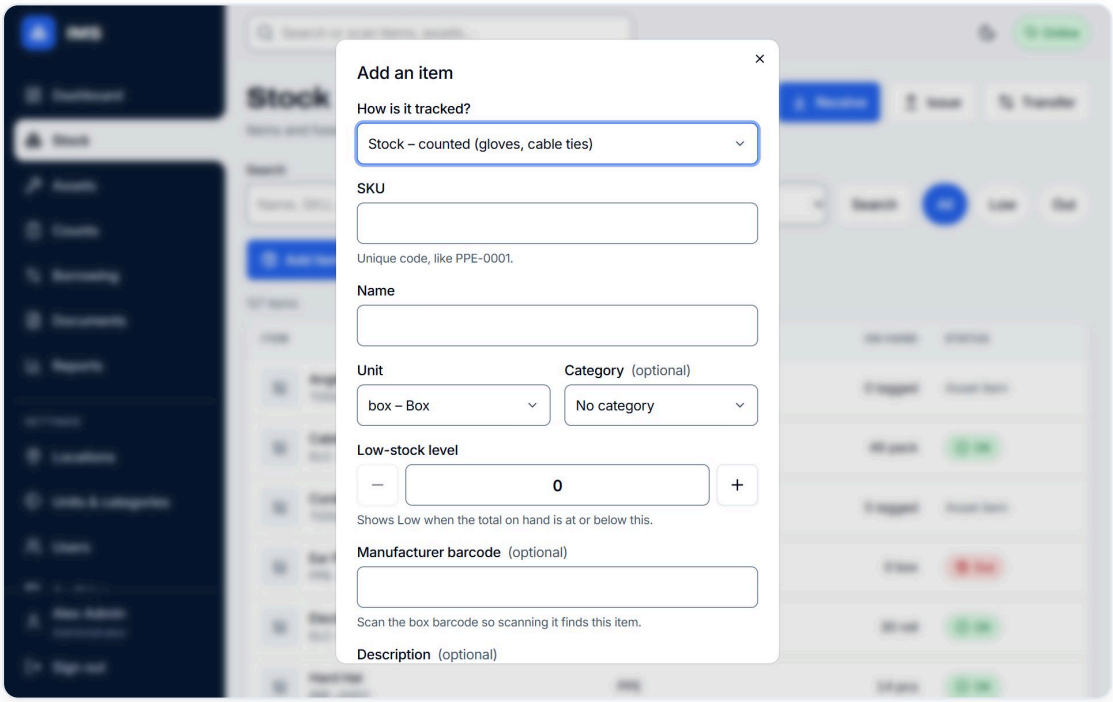
PART 2

Office: stock

5. Add items

One item

1. Open **Stock** and press **Add item** (below the search box).
2. **How is it tracked?**: choose **Stock** or **Asset** (see section 3).
3. Fill in **SKU** (a unique code, like `PPE-0001`), **Name** and **Unit**.
4. Optional: **Category**, **Low-stock level** (stock only), **Manufacturer barcode**, **Description**.
5. Optional: **Photo**. Choose a picture (on a phone you can take one) so everyone knows exactly which item it is.
6. Press **Add item**.



Add an item

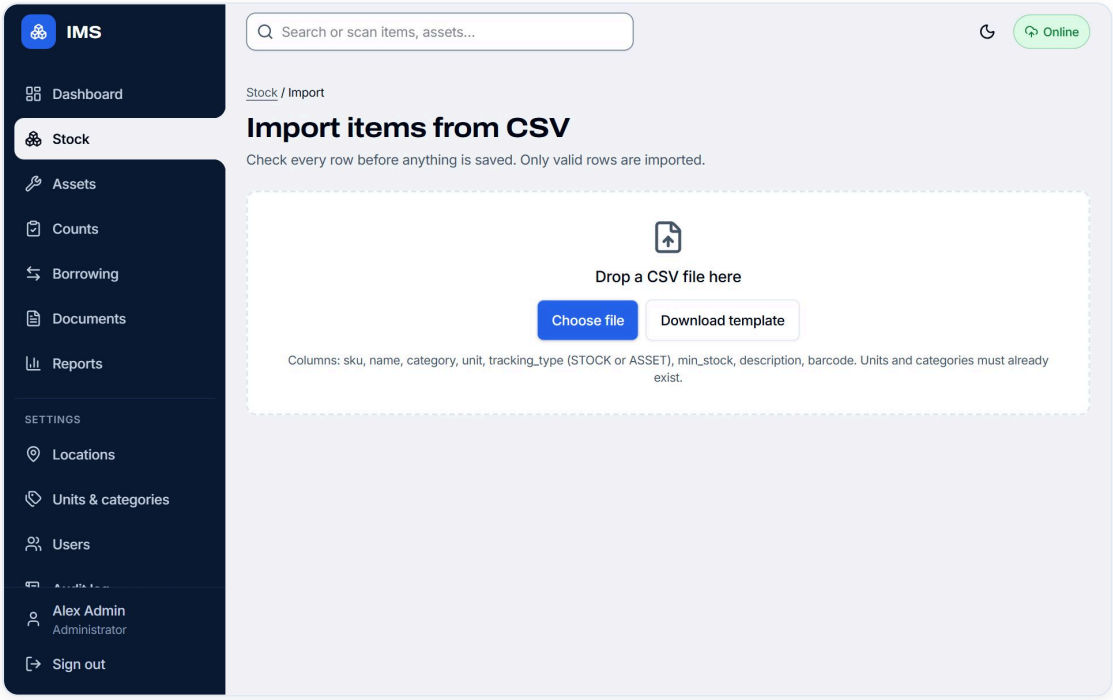
Tip: To add or change a photo later, open the item and press **Add photo** or **Change photo** (or **Remove**). Photos also show as small pictures in the **Stock** list.

Many items at once (CSV file)

1. Open **Stock** and press **Import CSV**.
2. Press **Download template** and fill it in with Excel (save it as CSV).

3. Press **Choose file** and pick your file.
4. Check the list: rows with a problem are red and say what's wrong. Fix them in the file and choose it again, or import only the good rows.
5. Press **Import … valid rows**.

Column	What to put	Required
`sku`	Unique code, like `PPE-0001`	Yes
`name`	Item name	Yes
`unit`	A unit code that already exists, like `pcs`	Yes
`tracking_type`	`STOCK` or `ASSET`	Yes
`category`	A category that already exists, like `PPE`	No
`min_stock`	Low-stock level (stock only)	No
`description`	Any detail	No
`barcode`	The manufacturer's barcode number	No



Import items from a CSV file

Warning: Units and categories must exist before you import. Add them first in **Units & categories** (section 21).

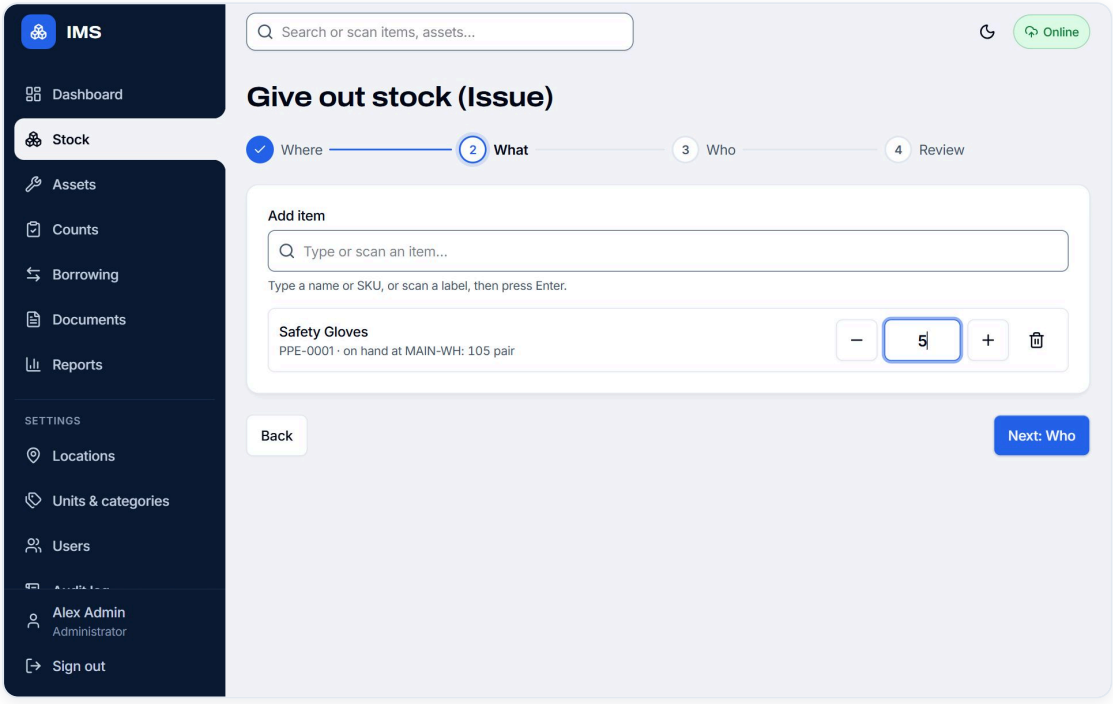
6. Receive stock (a delivery came in)

1. **Dashboard** → **Receive**.
2. **Receive at**: pick the location → **Next**.

3. **Add item**: scan or type the name or SKU, press Enter, then type how many. Repeat for each item → **Next**.
4. Optional: **Received from** (supplier) and **Delivery note / PO number** → **Next**.
5. Check the numbers → **Confirm receipt**.

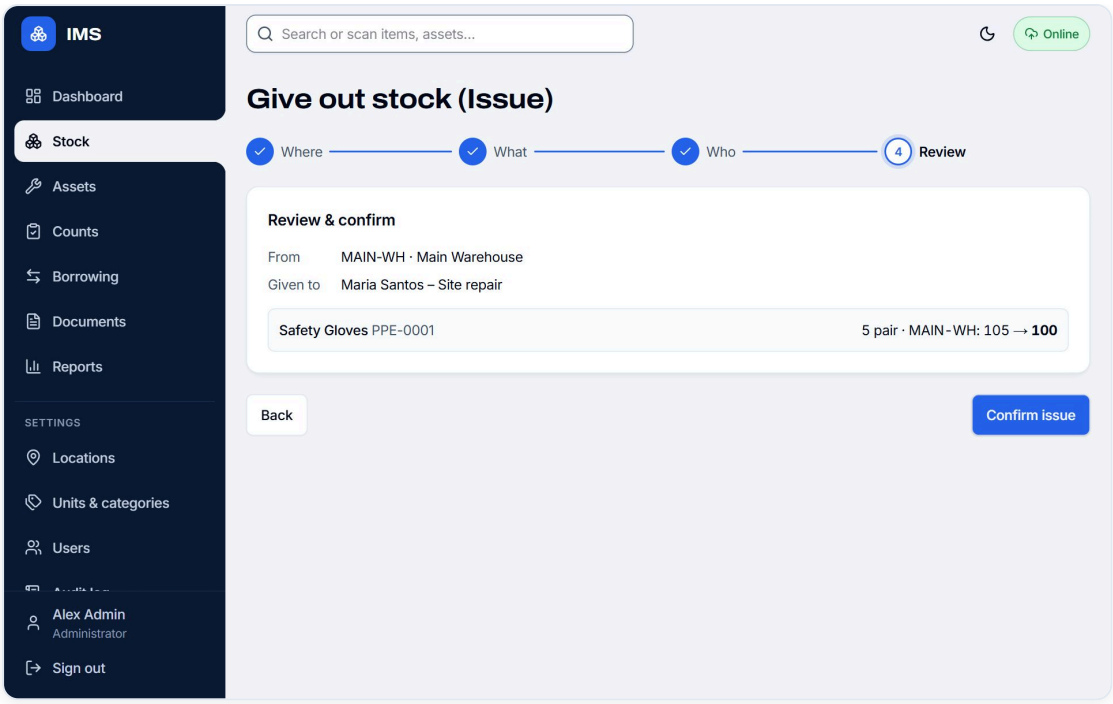
7. Give out stock (Issue)

1. **Dashboard** → **Issue**.
2. **Issue from**: pick the location → **Next**.
3. Add the items and how many → **Next**.



Issue, step 2: add items and quantities

4. **Given to** and **Purpose** (work order or reason) → **Next**.
5. Check the before → after numbers → **Confirm issue**.



Issue, step 4: review and confirm

6. Press **Print** or **Download PDF** to get the **Stock Issuance form** for signing.

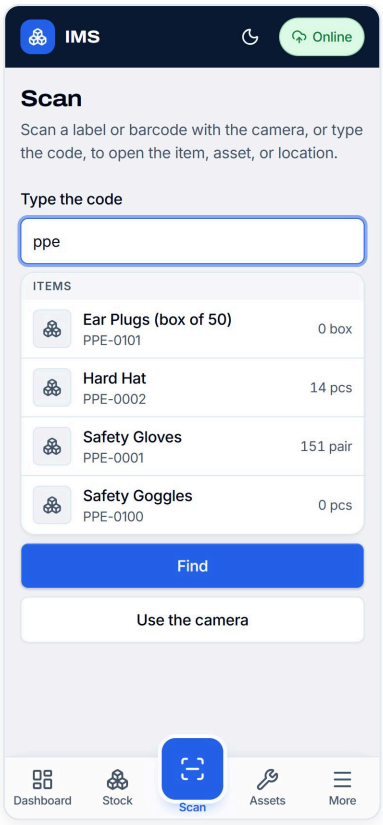
> **Tip:** If you ask for more than is on hand, IMS says how many are left (like "Only 3 pcs left at MAIN-WH"). Lower the quantity or pick another location.

8. Move stock to another location (Transfer)

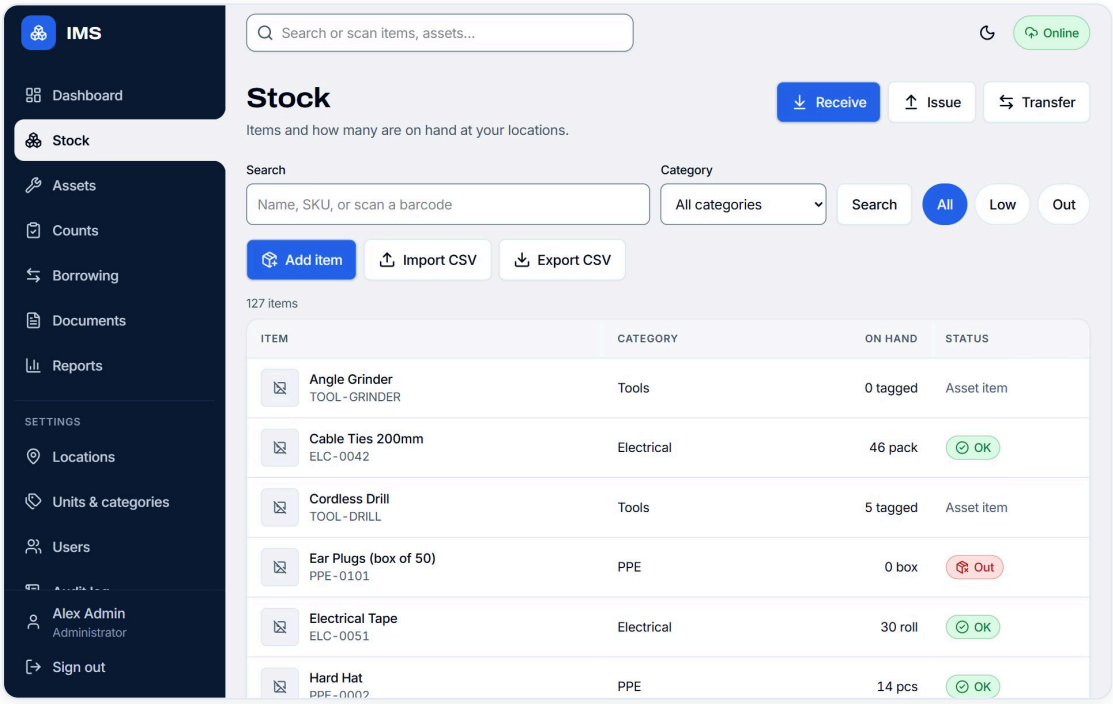
1. **Dashboard** → **Transfer**.
2. **From** and **To** → **Next**.
3. Add the items and how many → **Next**.
4. Optional: **Reason** → **Next**.
5. **Confirm transfer**, then print the **Transmittal form**.

9. Find anything

- **Search box** at the top: type or scan a name, SKU, asset tag, serial or barcode, then press Enter.
- **Scan** → **Type code instead**: start typing, even part of a SKU or name. Matching items, assets and locations appear under the box; tap one to open it.
- **Stock**: tap **Low** or **Out** to see what needs reordering, or pick a category.



Scan: suggestions while typing

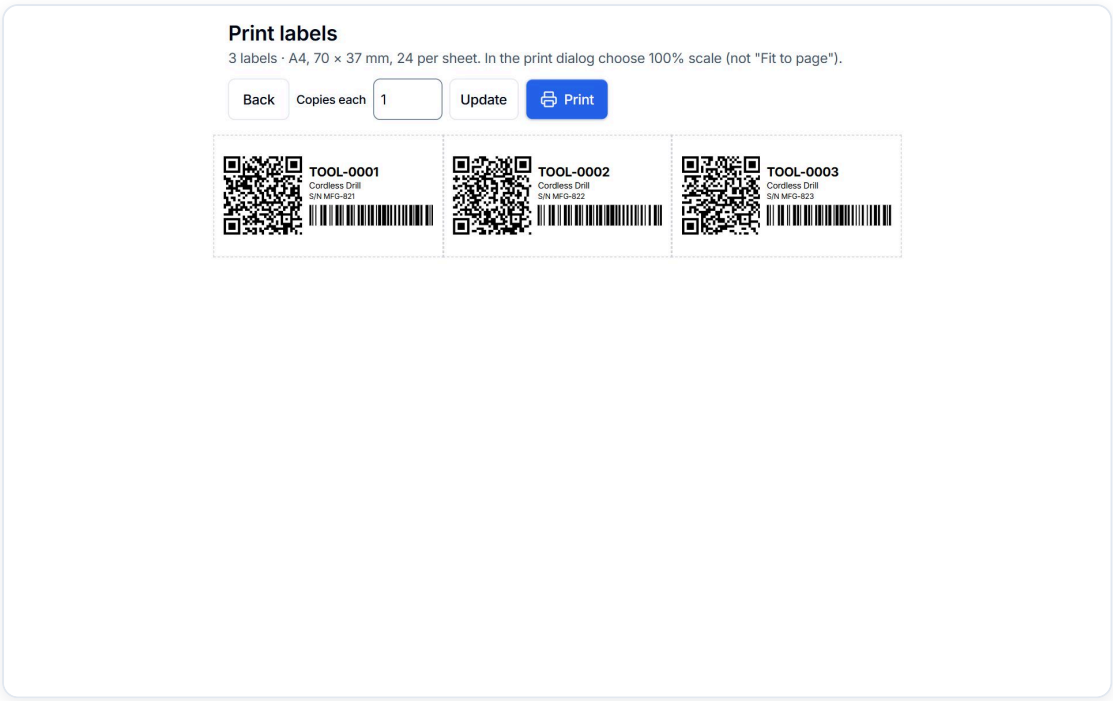


Stock list

10. Print labels

- **One item:** open the item → **Print label**.
- **One asset:** open the asset → **Print label**.
- **Many assets: Assets** → search or filter → **Print labels for this page**.

On the label page, set **Copies each** if you need more than one (press **Update**), then press **Print**.



Label sheet ready to print

Warning: Use A4 label paper with 3 × 8 labels (70 × 37 mm). In the print window choose **100% scale**, not "Fit to page", or the labels won't line up.

PART 3

Office: equipment

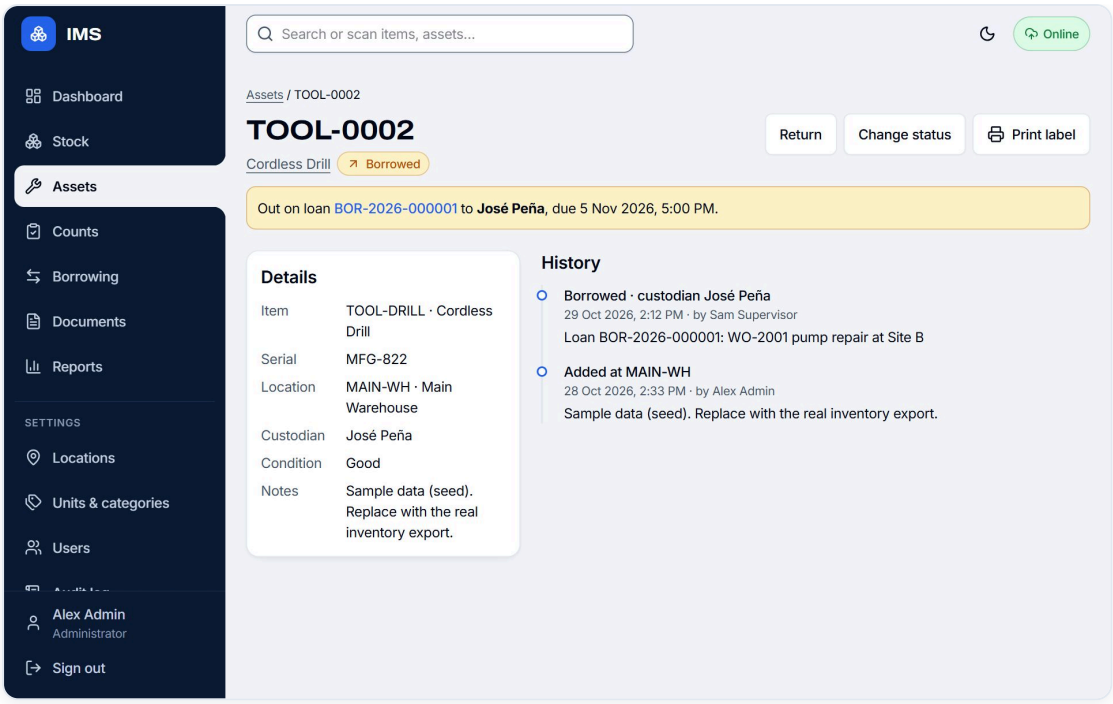
11. Add equipment (assets)

1. First make the item with **How is it tracked?** = **Asset** (section 5).
2. Open **Assets** → **Add assets** (or open the item → **Add assets**).
3. **Asset item**: type the item's SKU and pick it.
4. **Location**: where it's kept.
5. **How many?**: one tag is made for each.
6. **Tag prefix**: a short code like `LAP`. Tags become LAP-0001, LAP-0002…
7. **Condition**: Good, Fair or Damaged.
8. Optional: **Serial numbers** (one per line, same order as the tags), **Custodian**, **Notes**.
9. Press **Add … assets**.
10. Press **Print … labels** and stick one label on each unit.

12. See or change one asset

Open **Assets** → tap the asset. You see its details and its full history.

- **Borrow**: lend it (only when it's **Available**).
- **Return**: take it back (only when it's **Borrowed**).
- **Change status**: for example **Under maintenance**, **Needs review**, **Lost** or **Retired**. You must give a reason.
- **Print label**: reprint a lost or damaged label.



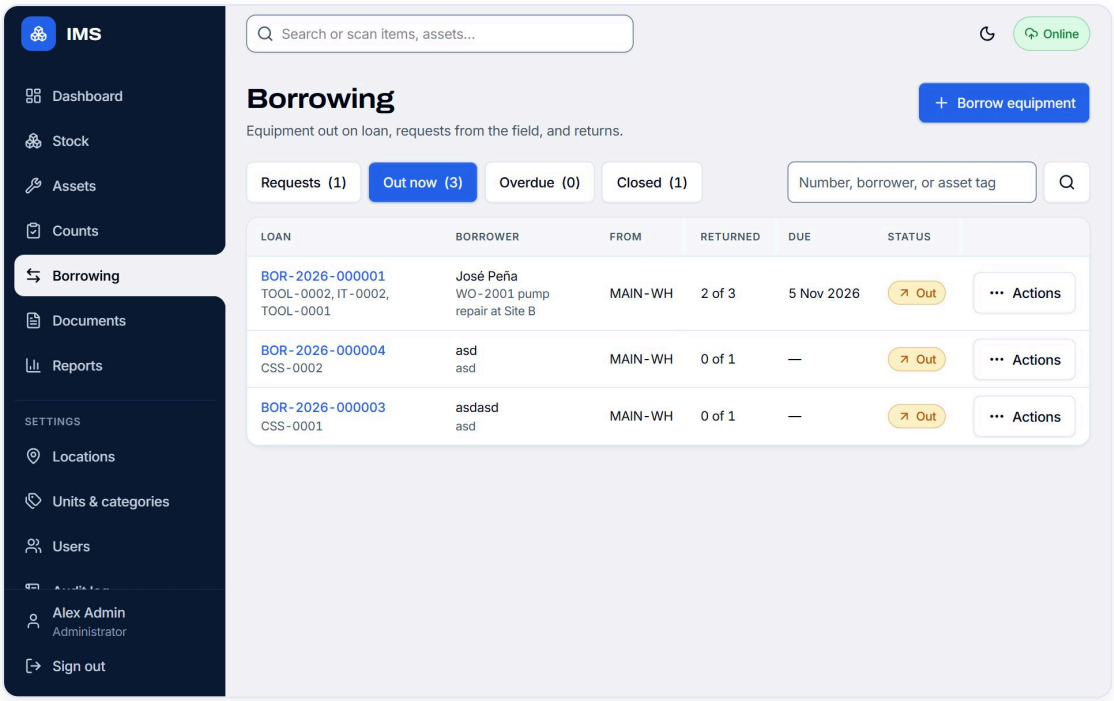
Asset page with history

Status	Means	What can happen next
Available	Ready to lend	Borrow, or change status
Borrowed	Out on a loan	Return (or mark Lost)
Under maintenance	Being repaired	Back to Available when fixed
Needs review	Came back damaged, or a count found it	Check it, then Available or Under maintenance
Lost	Can't be found	If found: Needs review first
Retired	No longer used	Nothing (permanent)

13. Lend equipment (Borrow)

1. **Borrowing → Borrow equipment**.
2. **Release from**: where the equipment is now → **Next**.
3. **Add asset**: scan or type each tag and press Enter. Set **Condition** and **Accessories** (like "charger, case") → **Next**.
4. **Borrower** and **Purpose**. Optional: **Department or site**, **Due back**, **Physically received by**, **Notes** → **Next**.
5. Check everything. Optional: **Prepared by** (who got the equipment ready; leave it empty to use your name). **Preview form (DRAFT)** shows the form before anything is saved.
6. **Confirm release**.
7. Print the **Equipment Borrowing form** and have the borrower sign it.

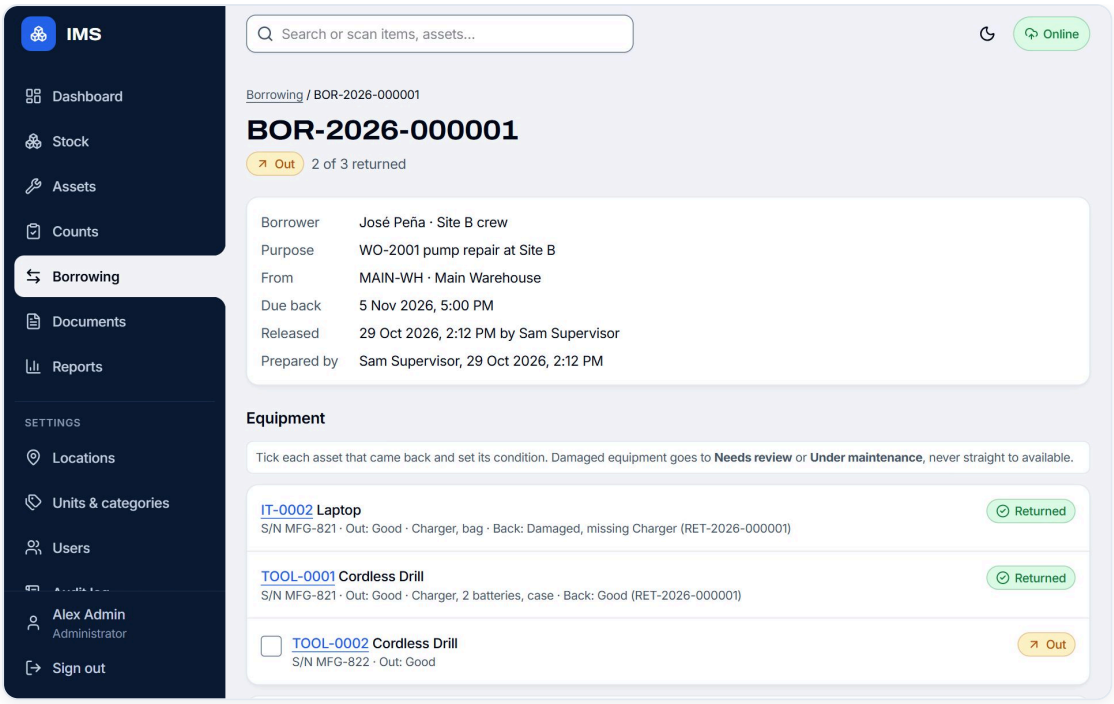
The **Borrowing** page has tabs: **Requests** (from field staff), **Out now**, **Overdue** (red) and **Closed**.



Borrowing list

14. Take equipment back (Return)

1. **Borrowing** → open the loan → **Return equipment**.
2. Tick each asset that came back.
3. **Condition now** for each. If it's **Damaged**, pick **Send to**: **Needs review** or **Under maintenance**.
4. Optional: **Missing accessories**, **Notes**.
5. **Brought back by** and **Received at**.
6. **Confirm return**, then print the **Return Acknowledgment**.



Loan page: tick what came back

Tip: You can return some items now and the rest later. The loan stays open until everything is back.

15. Release a borrow request from the field

1. **Borrowing** → **Requests** tab.
2. Open the request → **Check and release**.
3. Check the assets and details, then **Confirm release** as in section 13.

PART 4

Office: stock counts

16. Start a count

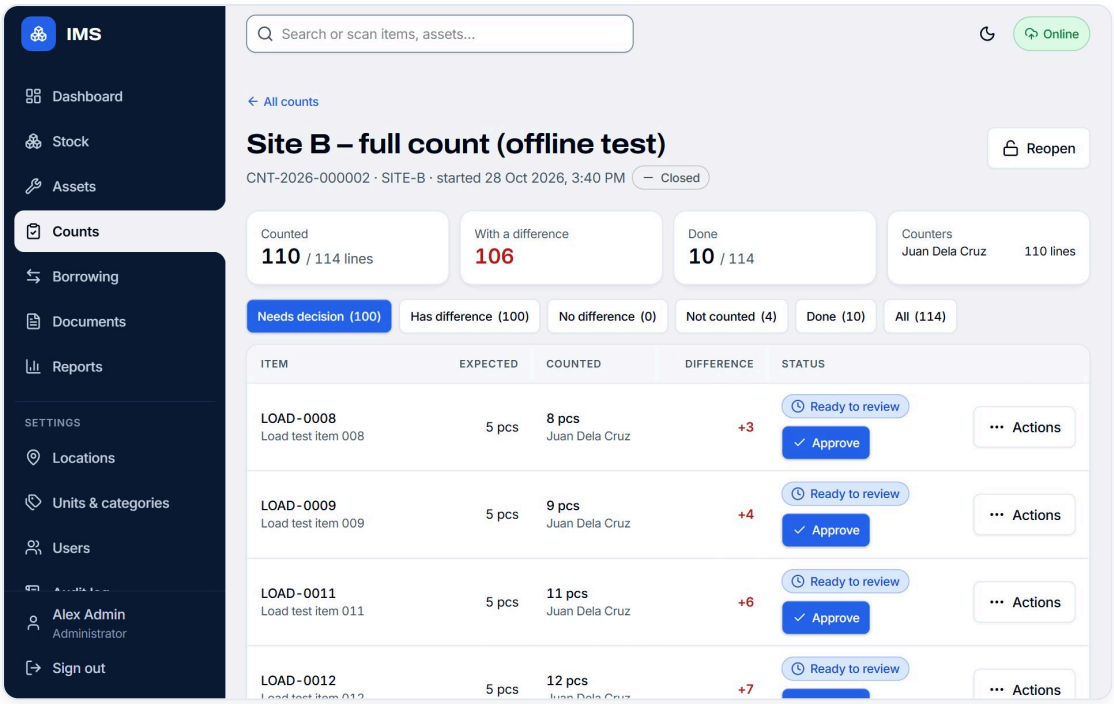
1. **Counts** → **New count**.
2. **Location to count** and a **Name** → **Next**.
3. **Count**: **Stock quantities** and/or **Tagged assets**. **Which items**: everything, or only some categories → **Next**.
4. **Who counts**: tick the people → **Next**.
5. Optional: **Finish counting by** and **Instructions for counters** → **Next**.
6. **Create count**.

The counters see it on their phones (section 25).

> **Warning:** While a count is open, stock at that location can't be received, issued or moved, so the numbers stay still. A supervisor can still do it by typing a **Reason for moving stock during the count**; those lines then need a recount.

17. Review and close a count

1. **Counts** → open the count. Each line shows what IMS expected and what was counted.
2. For each line:
   - **Approve**: set the stock to the counted number.
   - **Request recount** (in the line's menu): ask for it to be counted again.
   - **Keep expected** (in the line's menu): ignore the counted number.
3. **Approve … with no difference** approves every line that already matches, in one go.
4. When every line is decided → **Close count**. (**Reopen** undoes a close.)



Count review: expected vs counted

Tip: Counting alone never changes stock. Only **Approve** does, and it records an adjustment (ADJ-...) with your name. If two people counted the same thing differently, IMS asks you which count is right.

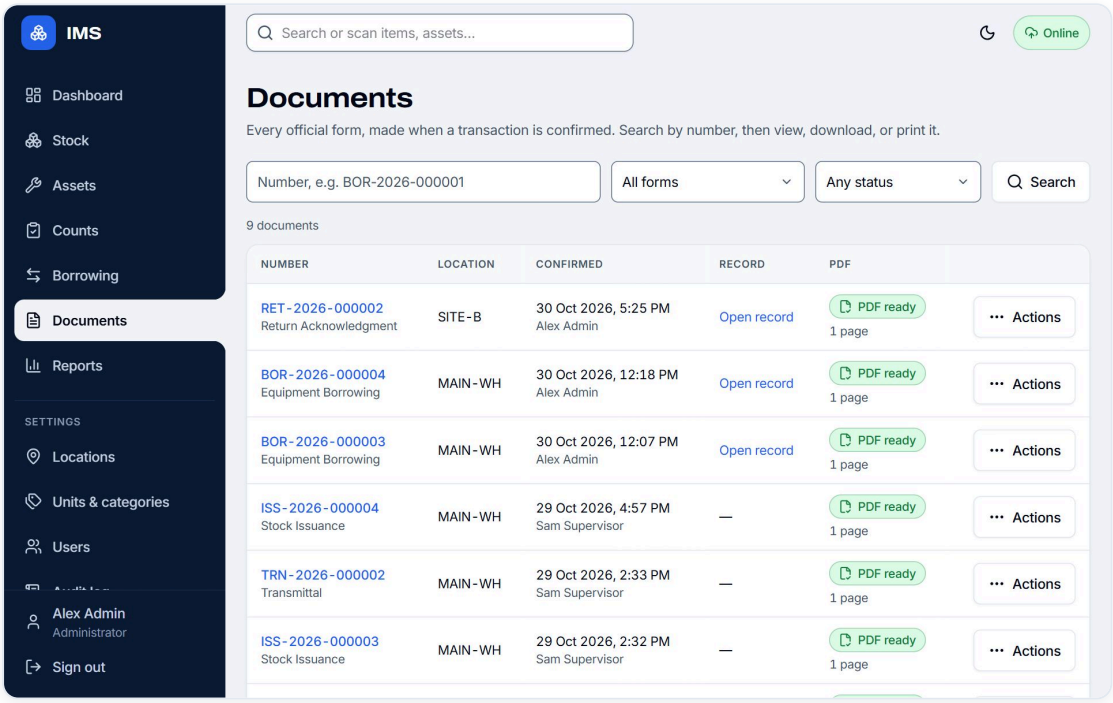
PART 5

Forms, reports and settings

18. Forms (Documents)

IMS makes 4 forms: **Stock Issuance**, **Transmittal** (transfers), **Equipment Borrowing** and **Return Acknowledgment**.

1. Open **Documents**.
2. Search by number (like `ISS-2026-000123`) or filter by form.
3. **View**, **Download PDF** or **Print**.

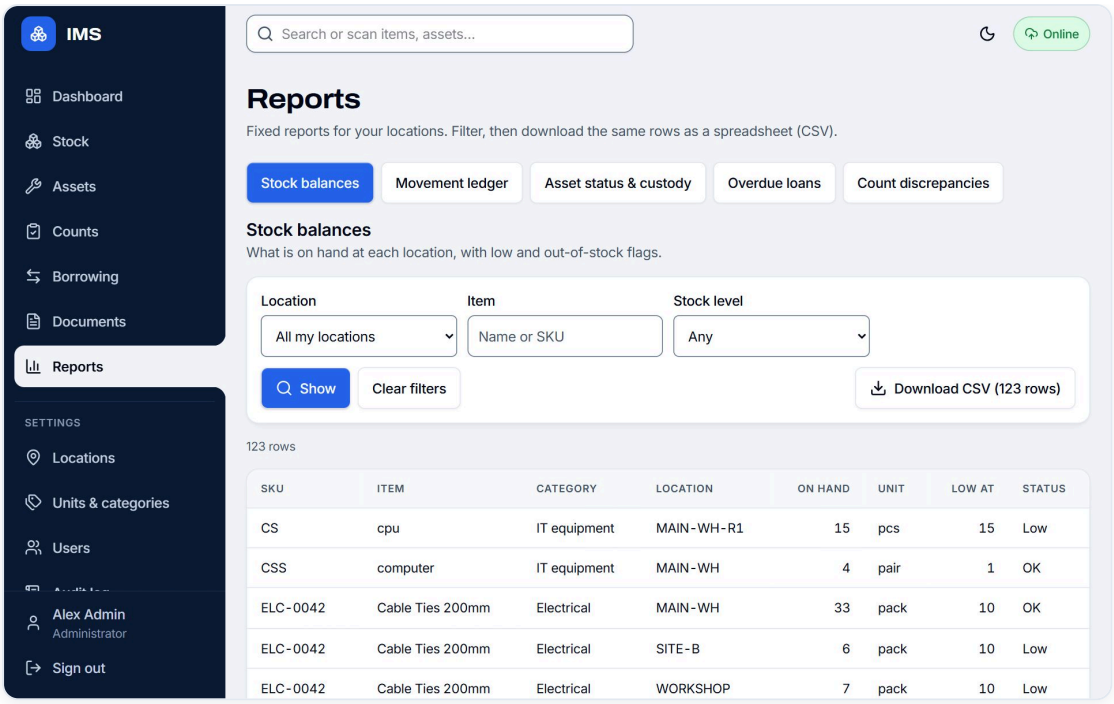


Documents list

Tip: If a form says "PDF failed", press **Retry PDF**. The stock or loan is already saved; this only remakes the form.

19. Reports

1. Open **Reports** and pick one: **Stock balances**, **Movement ledger**, **Asset status & custody**, **Overdue loans** or **Count discrepancies**.
2. Set the filters (location, dates, item...).
3. **Download CSV** to open it in Excel.

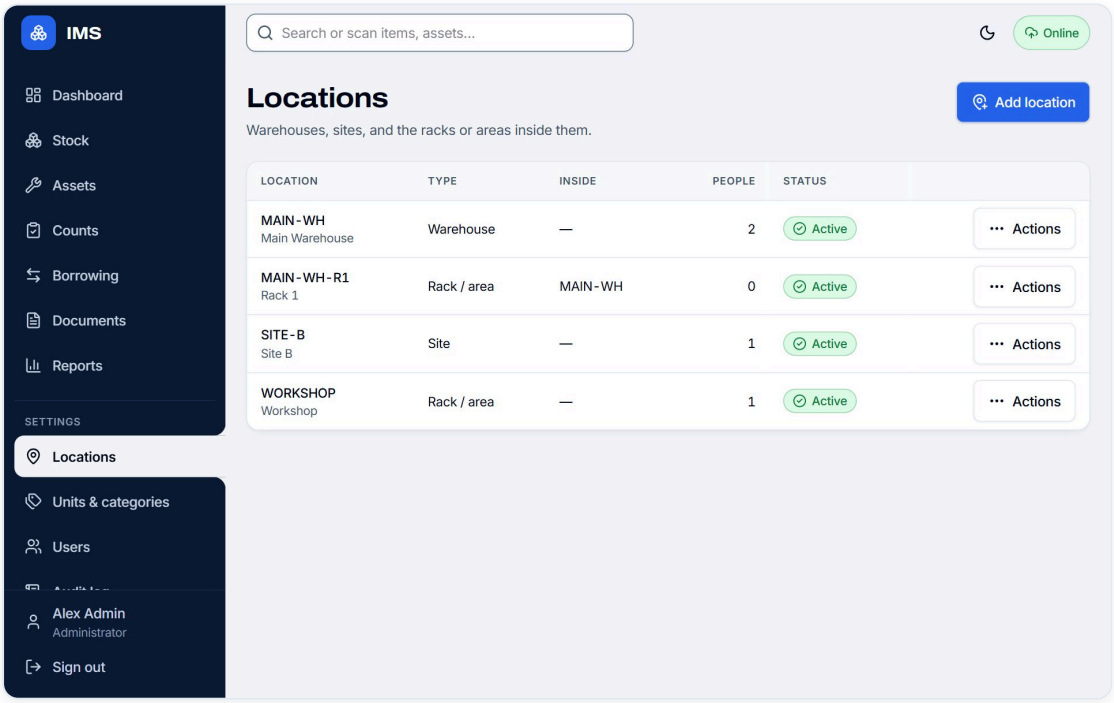


Reports

20. Locations

1. Open **Locations** → **Add location**.
2. **Code** (short and unique, like `WH-A` or `SITE-B-R1`), **Name**, **Type** (**Warehouse**, **Site** or **Rack / area**) and **Inside** (the location it belongs to, or **Top level (no parent)**).
3. Save.

Each row's menu has **Edit** and **Deactivate**. Codes can't be changed, because labels and forms use them.



Locations

21. Units & categories

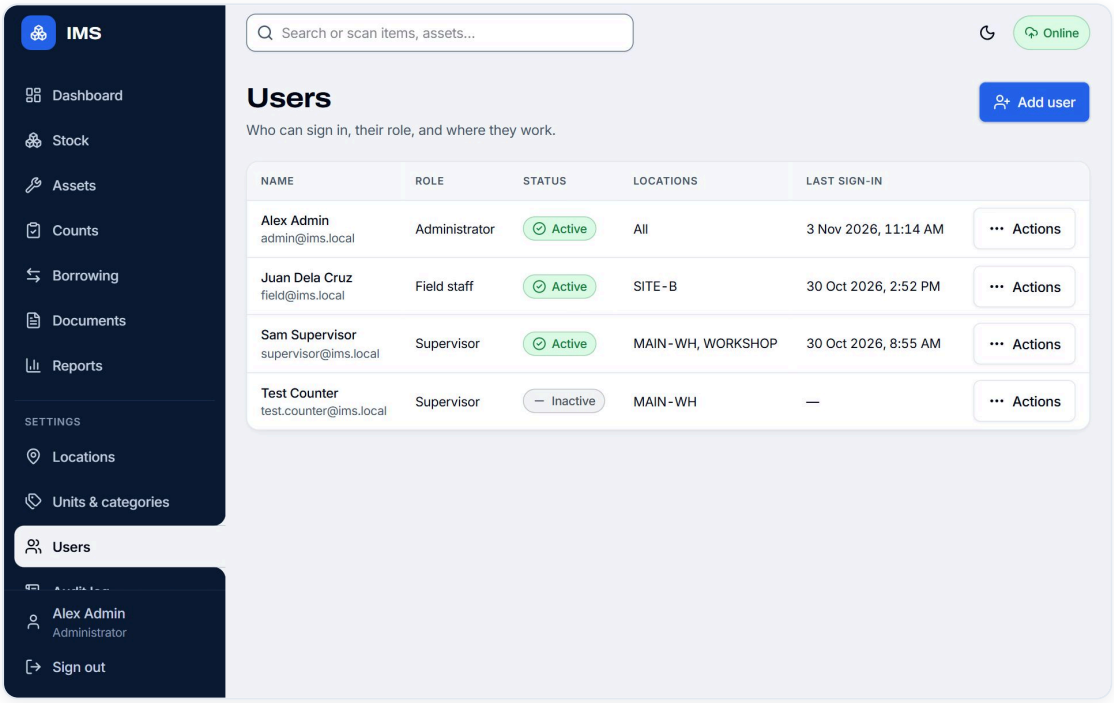
Open **Units & categories**:

- **Units**: type a **Code** (like `pcs`) and **Name** (like `Piece`) → **Add unit**.
- **Categories**: type a **Name** (like `PPE`) → **Add category**.

22. Users (administrators only)

1. Open **Users** → **Add user**.
2. **Full name**, **Email**, **Temporary password** (give it to the person directly, never by group chat).
3. **Role**: **Field staff**, **Supervisor** or **Administrator**.
4. **Locations**: pick where they work, with **Full** or **View only** access. Access includes everything inside a location.
5. Press **Add user**.

Each user's menu has **Edit**, **Reset link** and **Deactivate**. Deactivating signs the person out everywhere.



Users

23. Audit log (administrators only)

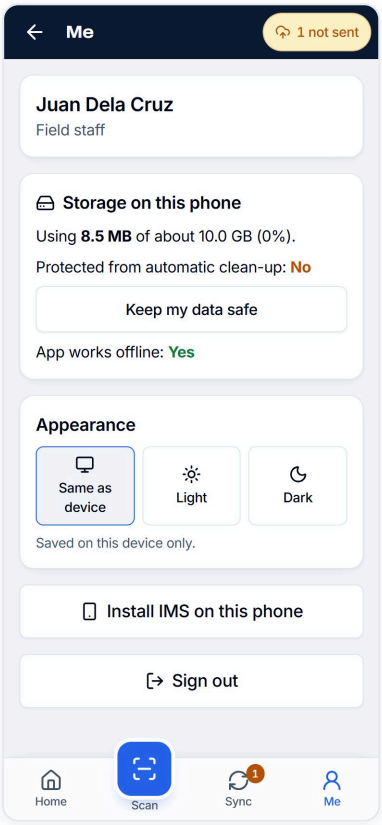
Audit log shows who did what and when: sign-ins, stock moves, approvals, changes to items, users and photos. No one can edit or delete entries in IMS.

PART 6

Phone: field staff

24. First time (needs internet)

1. Open the IMS link on your phone and sign in.
2. **Me** → **Install IMS on this phone** → follow the steps for Android or iPhone. (On iPhone: Share → **Add to Home Screen**.)
3. From now on, open IMS from the new icon on your home screen.

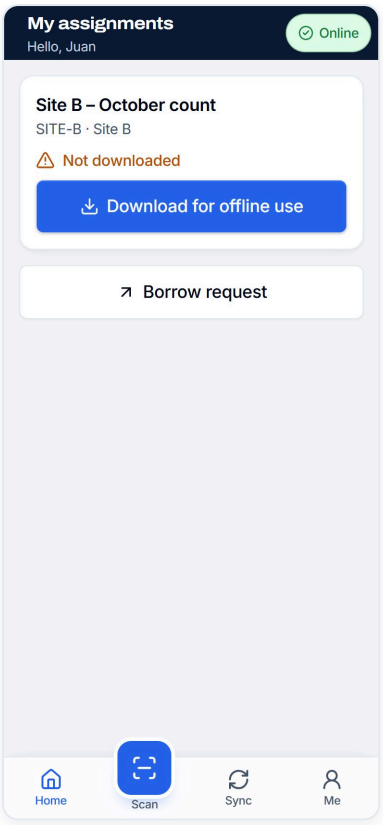


Me: install, storage, appearance

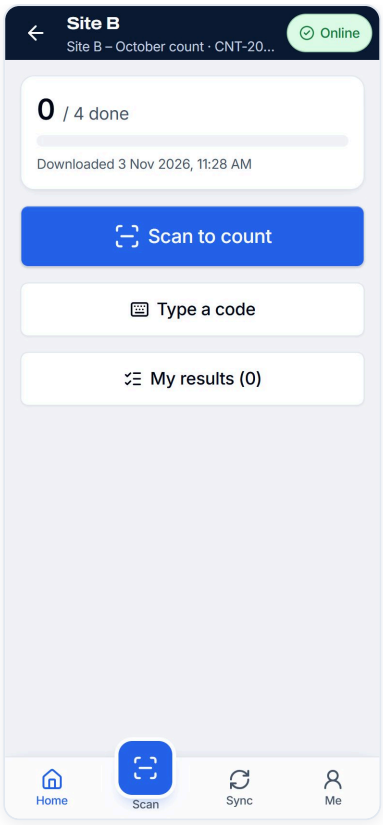
Warning: On iPhone the home-screen app keeps its own storage. Download your assignment again after installing.

25. Before you go out (needs internet)

1. **Home** → find your assignment.
2. Press **Download for offline use**.
3. Wait for **Ready for offline use**. Now it works without signal.



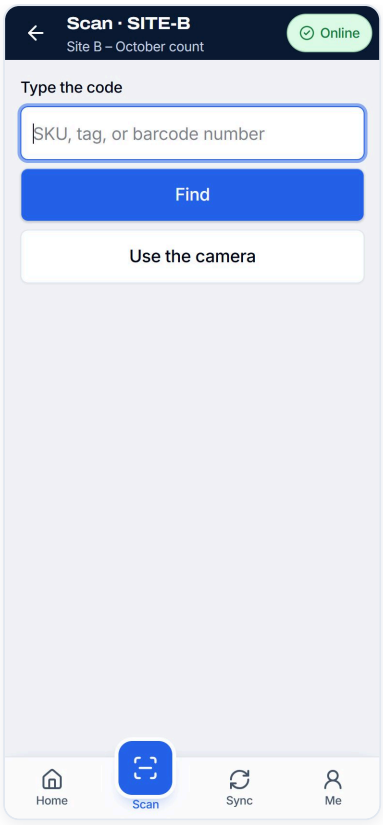
Home: download your assignment



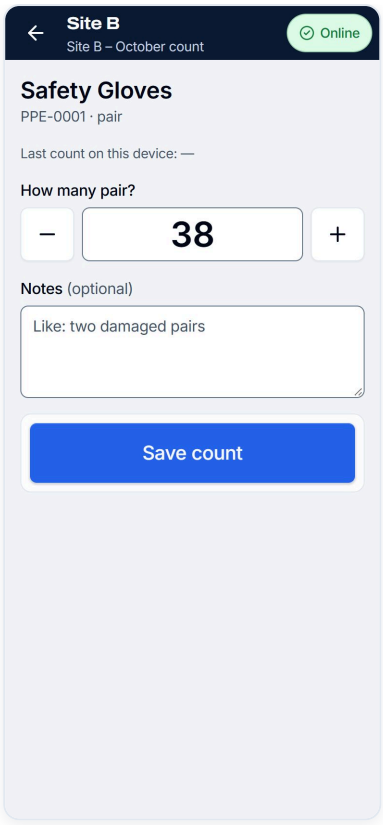
Assignment: scan to count

26. Count

1. Open the assignment → **Scan to count**.
2. Point the camera at the label. Camera not working? Press **Type a code**.
3. **Stock item:** type how many → **Save count**.
4. **Equipment:** tap **Found** or **Not found**. If found, pick the condition → **Save check**.
5. Scan the next one.



Type a code



Count screen: how many, then Save count

Tip: Scanned the same thing twice? It opens your saved count. It does **not** add it again.

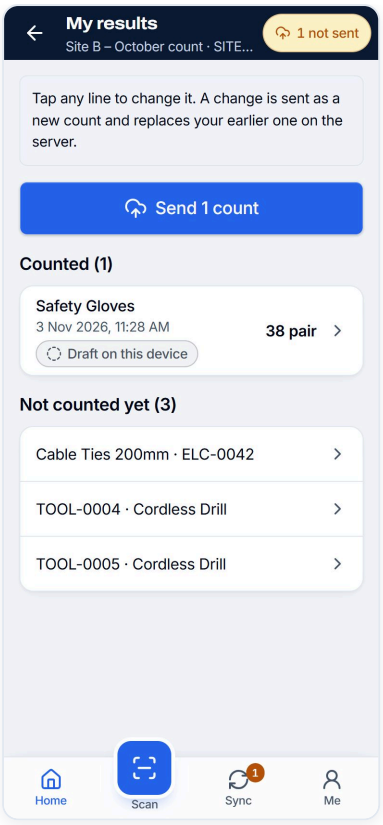
27. Check and fix your counts (My results)

1. Open the assignment → **My results**.
2. **Counted** and **Not counted yet** show your progress.
3. Tap any line to change it, then save again.

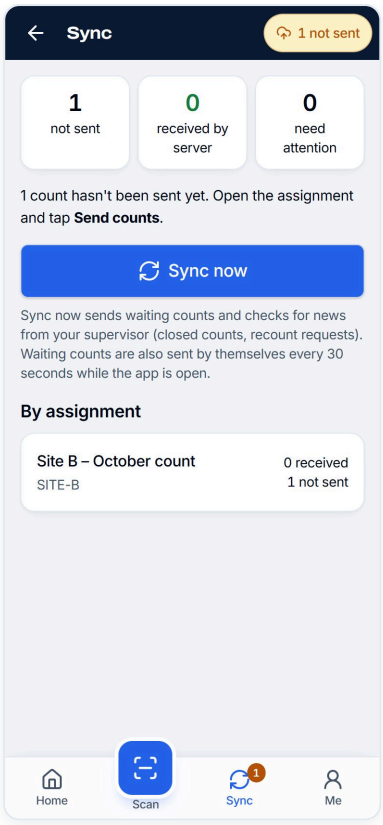
28. Send your counts (needs internet)

1. Open the assignment or **My results**.
2. Press **Send … counts** (like **Send 3 counts**).

The pill at the top shows where your counts are: **3 not sent** means still on your phone; **All sent** means the office has them.



My results: Send counts

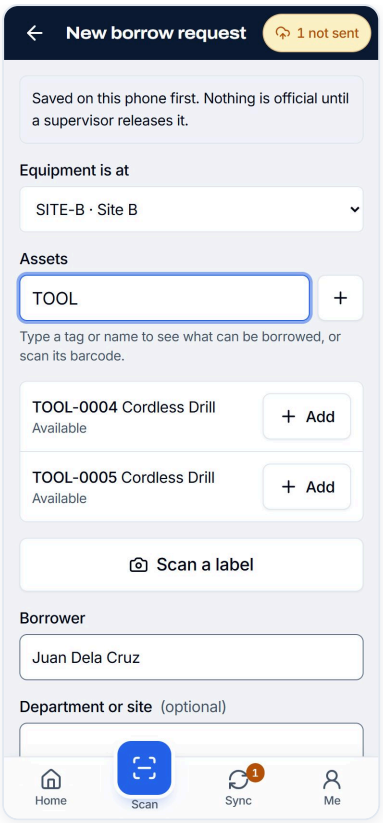


Sync screen

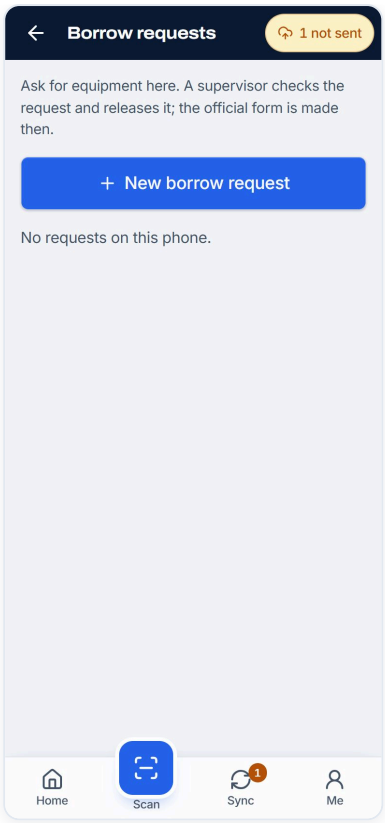
Tip: No signal? Your counts stay safe on the phone. Send them later from **Sync** → **Sync now**.

29. Ask to borrow equipment

1. **Home** → **Borrow request** → **New borrow request**.
2. **Equipment is at**: pick the location.
3. **Assets**: type a tag or name. Matching equipment appears; tap **Add** on one marked **Available**. Red text means it can't be borrowed (already out, under maintenance...) or isn't at that location. You can also **Scan a label**.
4. **Borrower** and **Purpose**. Optional: **Department or site**, **Notes**.
5. **Save on this phone**.
6. **Send to supervisor** (needs internet).



New borrow request: asset suggestions



Borrow requests

It's only a request. A supervisor checks it and does the official release.

30. Me

- **Appearance**: **Same as device**, **Light** or **Dark**.
- **Storage on this phone**: how much space IMS uses.
- **Install IMS on this phone**.
- **Sign out**. If you have counts that aren't sent, IMS warns you first. Signing out needs internet.

PART 7

Quick reference

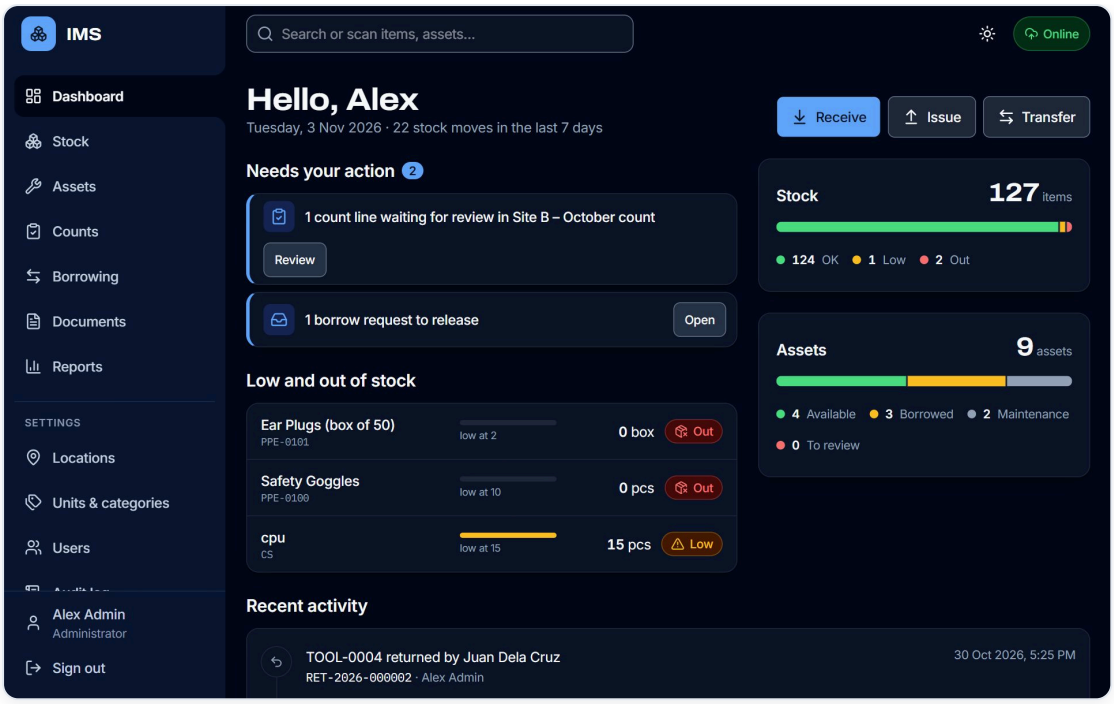
31. I want to...

I want to...	Go to
Add stock from a delivery	**Dashboard** → **Receive**
Give stock to someone	**Dashboard** → **Issue**
Move stock between locations	**Dashboard** → **Transfer**
Add a new kind of item	**Stock** → **Add item**
Add many items	**Stock** → **Import CSV**
Tag new equipment	**Assets** → **Add assets**
Lend equipment	**Borrowing** → **Borrow equipment**
Take equipment back	**Borrowing** → open the loan → **Return equipment**
Count a location	**Counts** → **New count**
Find an item, asset or location	Search box, or **Scan** → **Type code instead**
Print labels	Item or asset → **Print label**
Reprint a form	**Documents**
Get a spreadsheet	**Reports** → **Download CSV**
Add a person	**Users** → **Add user**
Count with my phone	**Home** → **Download for offline use** → **Scan to count**

32. What the colors mean

Color	Means
Green	OK · Available · Done · All sent
Orange	Low stock · Borrowed · Not sent yet
Red	Out of stock · Overdue · Problem, needs action
Grey	Inactive · Retired · Draft

Dark mode: tap the sun / moon button at the top, or **Me** → **Appearance**.



Dashboard in dark mode

33. Problems

Problem	Do this
Added something by mistake	Tick it in the list (**Stock**, **Assets**, **Locations** or **Users**) → **Delete selected**. Never-used records are deleted; used ones are hidden so their history stays. Assets are retired.
"Too many wrong attempts"	Wait 15 minutes, or ask an administrator for a **Reset link**
"... is counted stock, not an asset item"	That item is Stock. Make a new item with **How is it tracked?** = **Asset**
No **Add assets** button on an item	The item is Stock. Use **Receive** for it, or make a new Asset item
"Only 3 left" when issuing	Lower the quantity or pick another location
Stock moves are blocked at a location	A count is open there. Finish it, or give a reason to move stock during the count
Asset can't be borrowed	It's borrowed, under maintenance, lost or retired. Check its status on **Assets**
"PDF failed"	**Documents** → **Retry PDF**
CSV rows are red	Read the reason on each row; often the unit or category doesn't exist yet
Labels don't line up	Print at **100% scale** on 3 × 8 (70 × 37 mm) A4 label paper
Camera won't open	Allow the camera for IMS in the phone settings, or use **Type a code**

Problem	Do this
"Not downloaded"	Get internet, then **Download for offline use**
Counts stuck on "not sent"	Get internet → **Sync** → **Sync now**

34. Don't

- **Don't clear browser data or uninstall IMS** while counts are not sent. Unsent counts would be lost.
- **Don't share your account.** Everything you do is recorded under your name.
- **Don't go out of signal without downloading** your assignment first.

35. Words used in IMS

Word	Means
SKU	The item's unique code, like `PPE-0001`
Asset tag	One piece of equipment's unique code, like `TOOL-0001`
Location	A warehouse, site, or rack / area inside one
Receive	Stock coming in
Issue	Stock going out, not coming back
Transfer	Stock moving between two locations
Borrow / Return	Equipment going out and coming back
Custodian	The person responsible for a piece of equipment
Count	Checking what is really on the shelf against what IMS says
Adjustment	The change to stock when a count difference is approved (ADJ-...)
Low-stock level	When on-hand stock falls to this number, IMS shows it as Low